Analysing Bookstore Trends: Buyers, Behavior, and Beyond with Advanced SQL

🔎 CUSTOMER INSIGHTS | 📈 REVENUE PATTERNS | 📦 SALES TRENDS

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Business Context and Problem

- A mid-sized bookstore generates large volumes of sales data
- However, the business lacks structured insights to utilize this data effectively

Challenges

- No visibility into high-value customers
- Revenue trends are not tracked systematically
- Product performance is unclear

Impact

- Decisions are not data-driven
- Missed opportunities in marketing, inventory, and customer retention

Business Objective and Key Questions

Objectives

- Identify high-value customers and their purchasing patterns
- Analyze revenue trends over time
- Determine top-performing genres, books, and authors

Key Questions

- Who are the top revenue-generating customers?
- What is the average spend per order?
- Which genres drive the most sales?
- How does revenue change month-over-month?

Data and Approach

Data Source

- Orders, Customers, Books

Tools Used

- MySQL

Approach

- Joined datasets to create a unified view
- Used aggregations (SUM, COUNT) for metrics
- Applied window functions (RANK) for top categories
- Performed time-based analysis for trends

Customer Insights and Behavior

Analysis

- Total purchases and revenue per customer
- Average spend per order
- Favorite genres and purchase patterns
- Most purchased books and authors

Key Takeaway:

- Identifies high-value customers and their buying behavior

Sales and Product Performance

Analysis

- Monthly revenue, orders, and sales trends
- Top-selling genres by month
- Most frequently ordered books
- Top authors by total sales

Key Observations:

- Revenue varies across months (possible seasonality)Certain genres consistently perform well, specific books and authors drive major sales.

Key Insights

- A small group of customers contributes significantly to revenue
- High-performing genres dominate overall sales
- Revenue trends indicate seasonal demand patterns
- Certain books and authors drive repeat purchases

Business Recommendations

- **Customer Strategy**
  - Introduce loyalty programs for high-value customers
- **Marketing Strategy**
  - Promote top-performing genres and books
- **Inventory Strategy**
  - Maintain stock based on demand trends
- **Sales Strategy**
  - Run campaigns during low-performing months

Expected Business Impact

- Increased revenue through targeted campaigns
- Improved customer retention
- Optimized inventory planning
- More data-driven decision-making